OSHA Crane Operator Certification Checklist (29 CFR 1926.1427)

Use before an operator is assigned to a crane and during site inspections of crane work.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.1427

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item is a Defect, stop the operator from running the equipment until it is corrected, and record what was done.
3. The crane manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks beyond this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.1427: Operator training, certification, and evaluation (Subpart CC: Cranes and Derricks in Construction) Source: eCFR, Title 29, current as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-1427-operator-training-certification-evaluation

SECTION A | Certification and licensing

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Operator certified or licensed Ref. 1926.1427(c)	A certificate or license for the operator covers the equipment being operated	☐	☐	☐	
2	State or local license Ref. 1926.1427(c)(1)	Where the jurisdiction runs a qualifying crane operator licensing program, the operator holds that license	☐	☐	☐	
3	License in date Ref. 1926.1427(c)(1)(v)	License is within the period set by the licensing office and no more than 5 years old	☐	☐	☐	
4	Accredited certificate in date Ref. 1926.1427(d)(4)	Certificate from an accredited testing organization was issued within the last 5 years	☐	☐	☐	
5	Certificate equipment type Ref. 1926.1427(d)(2)	Certificate states the equipment type the operator is certified for	☐	☐	☐	
6	Audited-program certificate issuer Ref. 1926.1427(e)(6)(i)	An audited employer program certificate was issued by the operator's current employer	☐	☐	☐	
7	No cost to operator Ref. 1926.1427(c)(3)	Operator confirms the employer provided the certification or license without charging them	☐	☐	☐	
8	Test language recorded Ref. 1926.1427(h)(2)	Certification documentation notes the language the test was given in	☐	☐	☐	
9	Manuals and load charts language Ref. 1926.1427(h)(2)	Operations manual and load charts on the equipment are in the language of the certification	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Operator evaluation

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Evaluation record on site Ref. 1926.1427(f)(6)	Signed evaluation document for the operator can be produced at the worksite	☐	☐	☐	
11	Evaluation record contents Ref. 1926.1427(f)(6)	Record shows operator's name, evaluator's name and signature, date, and make, model and configuration of equipment used	☐	☐	☐	
12	Equipment matches evaluation Ref. 1926.1427(f)(5)	Crane in use was used in the evaluation, or the employer can show it needs no substantially different skills or knowledge	☐	☐	☐	
13	Assigned lifts covered Ref. 1926.1427(f)(1)(ii)	Blind lifts, personnel hoisting or multi-crane lifts planned for the operator were part of the demonstrated hoisting activities	☐	☐	☐	
14	Evaluator competence Ref. 1926.1427(f)(4)	Evaluator named on the record has the knowledge, training and experience to assess crane operators	☐	☐	☐	
15	Re-evaluation after retraining Ref. 1926.1427(f)(7)	Any operator retrained under (b)(5) has a re-evaluation on the retraining subject	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Operator-in-training supervision

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
16	Continuous monitoring Ref. 1926.1427(b)(2)	A trainer is on site watching the operator-in-training the whole time the equipment is operated	☐	☐	☐	
17	Trainer's employment Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(i)(A)	Trainer works for the trainee's employer or acts as its agent	☐	☐	☐	
18	Trainer not distracted Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(ii)	Trainer is doing no other tasks while monitoring	☐	☐	☐	
19	Line of sight (non-tower cranes) Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(iii)	Trainer and trainee can see each other directly and communicate by voice or hand signals	☐	☐	☐	
20	Direct communication (tower cranes) Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(iii)	Trainer and trainee are in direct communication	☐	☐	☐	
21	Trainer breaks Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(iv)(A)	Breaks last 15 minutes or less, with no more than one per hour	☐	☐	☐	
22	Break briefing Ref. 1926.1427(b)(4)(iv)(B)	Trainer told the trainee the specific tasks and limits immediately before the break	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Restricted work for operators-in-training

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
23	Power line clearance Ref. 1926.1427(b)(3)(i)	Trainee is not operating where equipment, load line or load could reach within 20 feet of a line up to 350 kV or 50 feet of a line over 350 kV	☐	☐	☐	
24	Personnel hoisting Ref. 1926.1427(b)(3)(ii)	Trainee is not operating equipment used to hoist personnel	☐	☐	☐	
25	Multiple-equipment lifts Ref. 1926.1427(b)(3)(iii)	Trainee is not operating in a multiple-equipment lift	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Restricted work for operators-in-training

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
26	Shafts, cofferdams and tank farms Ref. 1926.1427(b)(3)(iv)	Trainee is not operating over a shaft or cofferdam or in a tank farm	☐	☐	☐	
27	Multiple-lift rigging Ref. 1926.1427(b)(3)(v)	Trainee does multiple-lift rigging only where the trainer has determined their skills are sufficient	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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